be able to get to that side of immigration and passport control. I was wrong. Out of the corner of my eye, I saw a group of photographers and a couple of camera crews heading towards me, together with this little guy who I recognized from previous times; he'd always be running alongside you, whispering things to you and trying to provoke a reaction.

'Do you think you've let the team down, David? Have you let the country down? Do you realize what you've done, David? Should you be leaving the country right now?'

I had about two hundred yards to walk to the lounge. I slung my bag over one shoulder, just stared in front of me and marched on, not saying a word. It must have looked mad, with all these people trailing after me. Maybe it looked bad in the newspapers or on television, like I was running away. But I knew I just had to keep going. I couldn't afford to react in the wrong way now. I didn't need people telling me how bad I should be feeling. I already felt all that and worse. I wanted to be able to shut my eyes and be with Victoria. What could I do but try and blank the cameras out?

I made it to that finishing line and, a few minutes later, I was on the Concorde again. The flurry of snappers at Heathrow had given me an idea of what I could have expected had I stayed at home. As the plane took off, I assumed I was leaving all that behind: not my own disappointment about what had happened in Saint-Etienne, but having it stuck in my face by the media.

It was a little bit scary arriving at New York's JFK. I'd been to America before but this was the first time on my own. I walked up to the security checkpoint. There were these guards, with guns and dark sunglasses, looking really serious, wanting to know what was in this bag and that one. I'd arranged for a driver to meet me. As I walked out through the doors into the arrivals hall, there was a crowd of photographers, camera crews, and press waiting for me. *This is New York. This shouldn't be happening*.

I jumped into the car and went to close the door but there were people holding it open so I couldn't. It was ridiculous. I was having a tug of war with whoever was on the other side of the door. Then, when I got that one shut, the door on the other side of the car was pulled open, and a female photographer started snapping away at me in the back seat. I couldn't believe what was going on. I thought that, once I'd reached America, I'd be all right. Instead, I was in the middle of a scene from a movie: I'd never experienced anything like this back at home.